

Write Better jQuery Code for Your Project



jQuery, the cross-platform JavaScript library designed to simplify the client-side scripting of HTML, is used by over 80 per cent of the 10,000 most popularly visited websites. jQuery is free open source software which has a wide range of uses. In this article, the author suggests some best practices for writing jQuery code.

This article aims to explain how to use jQuery in a rapid and more sophisticated manner. Websites focus not only on backend functions like user registration, adding new friends or validation, but also on how their Web pages will get displayed to the user, how their pages will behave in different situations, etc. For example, doing a mouse-over on the front page of a site will either show beautiful animations, properly formatted error messages or interactive hints to the user on what can be done on the site.

jQuery is a very handy, interactive, powerful and rich client-side framework built on JavaScript. It is able to handle powerful operations like HTML manipulation, events handling and beautiful animations. Its most attractive feature is that it works across browsers. When using plain JavaScript, one of the things we need to ensure is whether the code we write tends towards perfection. It should handle any exception. If the user enters an invalid type of value, the script should not just hang or behave badly. However, in my career, I have seen many junior developers using plain JavaScript solutions instead of rich

frameworks like jQuery and writing numerous lines of code to do some fairly minor task.

For example, if one wants to write code to show the datepicker selection, on *onclick* event in plain JavaScript, the flow is:

1. For *onclick* event create one *div* element.
2. Inside that *div*, add content for dates, month and year.
3. Add navigation for changing the months and year.
4. Make sure that, on first client, *div* can be seen, and on second client, *div* is hidden; and this should not affect any other HTML elements. Just creating a datepicker is a slightly more difficult task and if this needs to be implemented many times in the same page, it becomes more complex. If the code is not properly implemented, then making modifications can be a nightmare.

This is where jQuery comes to our rescue. By using it, we can show the datepicker as follows:

```
$("#id").datepicker();
```

That's it! We can reuse the same code multiple times by